

Feedback on C142 - Discrete Mathematics

This year's exam has been a bit tougher than previous years, with certain parts that a lot of students found really difficult.

Question 1 Average performance: A.

- a) This part asked for some proofs; most students gave a good answer, although some wrote down an answer that did not constitute a proof. Average performance: A.
- b) The majority of students did this really well, some got stuck. Average performance: A.
- c) The first three parts were very done well; the fourth part, the most challenging part of Q1, stymied most students. Average performance: C.
- d) Again, done really well; marks were only dropped when writing down answers that were not proofs. Average performance: A+.

Question 2 Average performance: B.

- a) This part was done well; some students forgot to properly motivate their answer. Average performance: A.
- b) This was done much better than I expected; a lot of clear, well constructed, short proofs; but marks were dropped when writing down answers that were not proofs. Average performance: B.
- c) This was done a lot worse than I expected, seen that the exercise was so close to some we have done in the lectures. A lot of students forgot to deal with the 'finite' case. Average performance: D.
- d) This part was intended as the 'difficult one', and it has proven to be that. The result follows in one line from a result in the notes, but very few students realised that. Many students not even attempted this part; some that did use 'argumentation' rather than proofs for their answer. Average performance: F.
- e) I was expecting more for this part, seen that it appeared almost identically in the Xmas test. Many students not even attempted this part; some that did, confused the powerset with the set of all infinite sequences. Average performance: F.